

This all-or-none thinking is the exact wrong way to frame the conversation. This makes FI seem like a far off, unachievable goal. So most people never get started. Besides, it's absurd to think that one dollar more or less in a retirement account will change everything. Yet this way of thinking traps many of us on the path to FI. Rather than recognizing the progressive freedom and power our growing wealth provides, we often get caught up in the slog. Once we realize money is just a means to an end that allows us to live the lives we want, it's easy to see that we are progressively gaining power and freedom along the path to FI.

JL Collins, author of *The Simple Path to Wealth*, has popularized the phrase "F-you money" among the FI community. He described the concept as not necessarily having enough money to retire forever, but enough to say "F-you" if needed. Having F-you money allows a degree of freedom that most don't have.

Brad told the story of using the power of F-you money to leave his job as an accountant to pursue a different path in life. Anyone can relate to his experience of being bound to the rules and regulations of an employer. Here's how he described the straw that broke the camel's back in a conversation with Jonathan on the podcast: